

50 questions d'entretien FIC - FR / EN

À lire avant chaque entretien. Du plus simple au plus complexe.

Comment lire. Chaque question a : la réponse anglaise (à dire tel

quel, anglais

Sommaire : Bloc A actions (1-6) · B taux (7-14) · C obligations (15-22) ·

D dérivés

BLOC A - Actions (1-6)

1. What is a stock?

"A share of ownership in a company. You get a claim on its profits, usually

through divid

FR : part de propriété. Tu es actionnaire, dernier servi en cas de

faillite - d'o

2. What drives a share price?

"Expected future cash flows, discounted back. So two things move it: the

expectations

Focus. Cette réponse est parfaite parce qu'elle relie actions et

taux dès la

3. What is a dividend?

"Part of the profit paid out to shareholders. On the ex-dividend date, the

share price

4. What is market cap?

"Share price times number of shares. It's the market's valuation of the

equity, not o

5. What is an index?

"A basket tracking a market - the S&P 500, the CAC 40. Most are

market-cap

6. Long or short - what's the difference?

"Long means I own it and I profit if it goes up. Short means I sold something

I borrowed,

Vocabulaire A : *a share / a stock · a dividend · market cap · enterprise

value · to g

BLOC B - Taux (7-14)

7. What is discounting?

"Money today is worth more than money tomorrow. At four percent, a hundred

euros in one

FR : en 10 ans, ces 100 EUR ne valent plus que 67,56 EUR. Plus c'est loin,

moins ça va

8. Simple vs compound interest?

"Simple pays on the principal only. Compound pays on interest already earned.

Over long h

Rappel : règle de 72 -> à 6 %, un capital double en 12 ans (exact : 11,9).

9. What is the yield curve?

"It's the price of time - the rate demanded for each maturity. Normally it

slopes up, b

10. What does an inverted curve mean?

"Short rates above long rates. It usually means the market expects the central

bank to cut

11. Steepening or flattening?

"Steepening means the gap between short and long widens. Flattening means it

narrows. A l

Focus. Bull veut dire prix qui montent, donc taux qui

baissent. C'

12. What is a basis point?

"One hundredth of a percent. We say a bip. On ten million, one bip is a

thousand eu

13. What did the ECB just do?

"They hiked twenty-five bips, taking the deposit rate to 2.50 percent. The

market is pr

! Vérifie ce chiffre le matin même sur Yahoo Finance. Une donnée périmée

fait plus de r

14. Nominal vs real rate?

"Real is nominal minus inflation. If I earn three percent while inflation runs

at three, I've

Vocabulaire B : *to discount · the yield curve · steepening / flattening ·

a hike / a c

BLOC C - Obligations (15-22)

15. What is a bond?

"A loan in tradable form. I lend a hundred, I receive a coupon every year, and

I get the prin

16. * Why do bond prices fall when yields rise?

"Because my old bond becomes less attractive. If I hold a three percent bond

and the mar

Le chiffre : obligation 5 ans, coupon 3 % -> à 3 % elle vaut 100, à 4 %

95,55, à 5 %

Focus. C'est LA question du bloc FIC, celle qui élimine. Elle est

parfaite par

17. What is duration?

"The sensitivity of a bond's price to rates. A duration of five means: rates

up one perc

Le chiffre : l'obligation ci-dessus a une duration modifiée de 4,53.

18. And convexity?

"It's the gap between that approximation and reality. The price-yield

relationship

Le chiffre : -100 bp -> +4,66 % contre -100 bp -> -4,40 %.

19. What is DV01?

"The P&L for a one basis point move. On ten million with a modified duration

of 4.53, that

Focus. Répondre en euros par bip te fait passer d'étudiant à

quelqu'un q

20. Clean price vs dirty price?

"Dirty includes accrued interest, clean doesn't. Prices are quoted clean, but

you settle di

21. What is a repo?

"I sell a bond and agree to buy it back tomorrow slightly more expensive. It's

a secured lo

22. Why do banks hold government bonds?

"Liquidity and regulation - they're the highest quality collateral, and they

count toward

Vocabulaire C : *a coupon · at par · duration · convexity · DV01 · accrued

interest · re

BLOC D - Dérivés fermes (23-28)**23. What is a forward?**

"An agreement today to trade at a fixed price later. No cash upfront,

everything s

24. * Is the forward a forecast of the future price?

"No. It's the spot adjusted for cost of carry - what it costs to hold

the asset un

Focus. Le piège le plus fréquent en entretien FIC. Dire « non »

franchemen

25. Forward vs future?

"Same economics. A forward is OTC and bespoke with counterparty risk. A future

is exchange

26. What is an interest rate swap?

"Two parties exchange interest flows on a notional. One pays fixed, one pays

floating. The

27. Why would a company enter a swap?

"Say it borrowed floating and fears rates rising. It pays fixed and receives

floating, so i

28. Paying fixed - am I long or short duration?

"Short duration. I profit when rates rise. Paying fixed is economically

like being sh

Focus. Question de tri classique. Le raccourci à mémoriser : payer

fixe = vendre

Vocabulaire D : *cost of carry · contango / backwardation · OTC · to clear ·

margin call

BLOC E - Options (29-38)**29. What is an option?**

"It's insurance. I pay a premium for the right, not the obligation, to

buy - a call -

30. Buyer vs seller?

"The buyer's loss is capped at the premium, the upside is open. The seller

collects the

31. In the money, at the money, out of the money?

"In the money means exercising is profitable today. At the money means the

strike equals

32. What is put-call parity?

"A long call plus a short put at the same strike replicates a forward on the

underlying. :

Le chiffre : $S=100$, $K=100$, $r=4\%$, $q=2\%$, $T=0,5$, $C=6,20 \rightarrow P = 5,2149$

33. What is Black-Scholes, in one sentence?

"It prices an option by replication: you can copy the option by holding a

quantity of th

Focus. Répondre « c'est une formule » est faible. Répondre

« réplication

34. Name the assumptions. Which breaks first?

"Lognormal returns, constant volatility, constant rates, no transaction costs,

perfect divis

35. What is delta?

"How much the option moves when the underlying moves. It's also the hedge

ratio - how n

36. What is gamma?

"How fast delta changes. In plain terms: how quickly my hedge goes stale."

37. * You're short gamma and the market gaps. What happens?

"My delta moves against me. The market rallies, my delta goes short, so I have

to buy. It sel

Focus. La meilleure question pour te démarquer. Ajoute une phrase

vécue : *"I s

38. Theta and gamma - the link?

"You pay for convexity with time decay. Long gamma means I want movement and I

pay theta for

Vocabulaire E : *a premium · a strike · to exercise · in the money · delta

hedge · to g

BLOC F - Volatilité (39-42)

39. Realised vs implied volatility?

"Realised is what the market did - a calculation on past data. Implied is

what the ma

40. Is implied vol a forecast?

"It's a price, not a forecast. It's the vol level that makes the formula

match the q

Focus. Dire rich et cheap plutôt qu'expensive est le marqueur

le plus rapid

41. Why does the smile exist?

"Because real returns have fat tails - crashes happen more often than a

normal distr

42. Straddle or strangle?

"A straddle is a call and a put at the same strike - I'm betting on

movement,

Le chiffre : straddle 24,40 contre strangle 10,69 - le straddle

coûte 2,3x p

Vocabulaire F : *implied vol · realised vol · rich / cheap · fat tails ·

the smile ·

BLOC G - Crédit et FX (43-46)

43. What is a credit spread?

"The extra yield over the government curve - the price of default risk. A

150 basis po

44. Tightening or widening?

"Tightening means spreads narrow - the market is more confident. Widening

means stres

45. What is a CDS?

"Insurance against default. I pay an annual premium, and I'm compensated if

the issuer d

46. What drives an FX forward?

"Only the interest rate differential - nothing about direction. If dollar

rates are hig

Le chiffre : EURUSD 1,0850, $r_{USD}=4,25\%$, $r_{EUR}=2,25\%$, 3 mois ->

F = 1,09043

Vocabulaire G : *a spread · to tighten / to widen · investment grade / high

BLOC H - Structuration (47-50)

47. What is a structured product?

"A packaged payoff, usually a bond plus options. A classic is capital

protection: n

Focus. Cette réponse est parfaite parce qu'elle décompose le produit

au lieu de le

48. What is an autocall?

"A note that redeems early if the underlying is above a barrier on an

observation

49. Why does a client buy a structured product rather than the option?

"Format and access. It comes as a single security with one price, it fits in

their manda

50. Where does the bank make its money?

"On the spread between the payoff sold and the cost of hedging it. The

desk replica

Focus. Réponse honnête et lucide. Beaucoup de candidats disent « des

frais ». Dire

Vocabulaire H : *a payoff · capital protection · a zero-coupon · a barrier ·

an autocall

BLOC I - Ton profil (51-60)

51. Tell me about yourself.

"I'm Calvin, a final-year Master's student at SKEMA in Paris, focusing on

market finan

52. * What is ShockDesk?

"It's a research desk I built. I publish a dated macro forecast - say an

oil shock - th

Focus. Ne commence jamais par le P&L. Commencer par la méthode

désamorce

53. Why should I believe your numbers?

"Because the failures are on the same page as the wins. On the oil book, HYG

and TLT bot

54. Your alpha is negative - why should I be impressed?

"You're right, and it's on the page: the book made 1.32 percent while the S&P

did 3.05. Bu

Focus. La séquence gagnante : reconnaître -> recadrer -> annoncer le

correctif. Ne

55. Is this real money?

"No - it's a backtest on real market data, and I'd never present it as

anything els

56. Why Deutsche Bank?

"Two reasons. Positioning: DB is the number one European FIC house, and

the strategy

57. Why rates rather than equities?

"Rates is where a view has to be expressed precisely. In equities you can

be roughly r

58. Why not corporate finance, given your Master's?

"Because I found out what I actually enjoy is being marked to market every

day. In corpo

Focus. Ta formation Corporate Finance sera questionnée. Cette

réponse la t

59. What's your weakness?

"Speaking markets in English. I read and write it fine, but I'd never

practised tal

60. Do you have any questions for me?

"Yes. I keep finding that getting the direction right matters less than

getting the t

Focus. Ne termine jamais par « non ». Cette question fait trois

choses : elle

Les 5 phrases de secours

Situation	À dire
Répéter	"Sorry, could you repeat that?"
Gagner 3 secondes	"That's a good question - let me think."
Tu ne sais pas	"I don't know that one yet. Can you walk me through it?"
Te corriger	"Actually, let me correct myself."
Conclure	"That's how I'd approach it."

« I don't know » dit calmement est un atout. Un junior qui invente est

dangereux s

Les 3 pièges de prononciation

bond /bond/ - pas « bonde » · yield /yeeld/ - pas « yeld » ·

coupon /ko

Les 6 réponses à connaître par cur

Si tu manques de temps, ne relis que celles-là :

16 prix/taux inversés · 24 le forward n'est pas une prévision ·

34 la vol co